

A Thought on Parashat Bereishit

Dvar Torah - a printable page



In Parashat Bereishit, when the Torah describes the creation of man, it says that G-d said, "Let us make man in our image, after our likeness," and afterwards, "In the image of G-d He created him." We all know that G-d has no particular shape or form, since Hashem is infinite. So what does it mean that G-d created man in His image and likeness?

The answer is that just as G-d influences the entire world and everyone depends on Him, so too He created man in His image and likeness - meaning, He gave man the power to be, in a sense, a ruler over the world.

Most people think that the deeds of the great tzaddikim really matter, while simple people don't count for much - but that isn't true. Yes, the closer a person is to Hashem, the greater his power, but every Jew has tremendous power, even the simplest Jew. A Jew who does a good deed, who overcomes his inclination, or who thinks a good thought, has a positive effect on the entire world. We must never underestimate ourselves. We need to remember that we are children of a King - the children of Hashem. Our soul is divine, and every Jew has a direct connection to Hashem.

Shabbat Shalom, and a blessed one!